

**TURKISH
TRADITIONAL**
(ARRANGED BY KIAN RAVAEI)

**GELEVERA
DERESI**

for mezzo-soprano
and piano

ÆI edition

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(2024)

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*Commissioned by Feride Büyükdenktas.
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PROGRAM NOTE

Popularized by singer and activist Kâzım Koyuncu (1971–2005), *Gelevera Deresi* is a well-known folk song from the Black Sea region of Turkey. Like many in Turkey's northern coast, Koyuncu's health deteriorated in the years following the Chernobyl disaster, leading to his premature death from cancer at age 33.

My arrangement—a collaboration with Turkish mezzo-soprano Feride Büyükdenktas—reimagines the tragic love story of *Gelevera Deresi*, but with the Chernobyl disaster as the beloved's cause of death. Amidst melodic shrapnels that evoke the *kemençe*, a Turkish spiked fiddle, the piano intones deep, rumbling chords—a distant explosion. The singer mourns her beloved, who, in the grand scheme of things, is one of many beloveds poisoned by radiation in Chernobyl's wake.

—Kian Ravaei

TEXT & TRANSLATION

Koyverdun gittun beni Allah'undan bulasun
Kimse almasun seni yine bana kalasun

Sevdiğüm senun aşkun ciğerlerumi dağlar
Hiç mi düşünmedun sen sevdiğün boyle ağlar

Gelevera deresi iki dağın arası
Yuzunden silinmesun piçağumun yarası

Sevdiğüm senun aşkun ciğerlerumi dağlar
Hiç mi düşünmedun sen sevdiğün boyle ağlar

You left me and went away, may God curse you!
May no one take you, and may you be mine again.

My beloved, your love breaks my heart.
Didn't you think your beloved would cry like this?

Gelevera Brook is between two mountains.
May my blade scar your face forever.

My beloved, your love breaks my heart.
Didn't you think your beloved would cry like this?

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

My sincerest thanks to Feride Büyükdenktas and Valerie Coleman, whose guidance was essential in the creation of this work.

duration ca. 5'

to Feride Büyükdenktas

GELEVERA DERESI

Turkish Traditional

Turkish Traditional

Freely, senza misura ♩ = 60

Arranged by Kian Ravaei (2024)

p emotionally withdrawn

Mezzo-Soprano

Koy - ver - dun git - tun be - ni oy koy - ver - dun git - tun be - ni

Piano

pp a distant explosion

2

Al - lah - 'un - dan bu - la - sun oy Al - lah - 'un - dan bu - la - sun

mf pp

3 ♩ = 44, accel. poco a poco.....

precipitando, like black rain

8va

pp cresc......
(con Ped.)

(accel.).....

[3] (8)

mf cresc......

(accel.).....Freely ♩ = 88

[3] (8)

f *fff martellato* *f* *p dolce*

4 Quasi rubato ♩ = 72 *p* heartbroken

Koy - ver - dun git - tun be - ni_ koy - ver - dun git -

8va 5 8va 5 5

pp bring out melody

(sempre con Ped.)

8

-tun be-ni_____ Al-lah- 'un-dan bu-la-sun__

12

Al-lah- 'un-dan bu-la-sun Kim-se al-ma-

poco

p

15

-sun_____ se-ni oy kim-se al-ma-sun_____ se-ni

poco

p

18 *poco*

yi - ne ba - na ka - la - sun Kim - se al - ma - sun _____ se - ni oy

mf pp p

8va

5

22

kim - se al - ma - sun _____ se ni yi - ne ba - na ka - la - sun

8va

8va

pp

5

5

Red.

26 pushing forward

8va

p espr.

mf

5

5

5

5

a tempo

f with pain

29

Sev - duğum se - nun aş - kun_

f agitato

32

ci - ğer - le - ru -

f

8^{va}

35

- mi dağ - lar_

More rubato

pp

37

Hiç mi du - şun me - dun sen

8^{va}

5

3

5

pp

40

Hiç mi du - şun me - dun sen oy

8^{va}

5

5

5

43

sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_ sev - duğun boy -

5

46 *poco* *p*

-le ağ - lar Hiç mi du - şun me - dun sen

mf *pp* *p* 5 3

49 *poco*

Hiç mi du - şun me - dun sen oy

pp *p* 8va 5 5 5 *poco*

52 *rit.*

sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_ sev - duğun boy - le ağ -

56 ♩ = 44, accel. poco a poco

56

8va

-lar

pp

Measures 56-57: Musical score for measures 56-57. The score is in 4/4 time. Measure 56 features a vocal line starting with a dotted quarter note, followed by a piano accompaniment with eighth notes and chords. Measure 57 continues the piano accompaniment. The dynamic is marked *pp* (pianissimo).

(accel.)

57

8va

pp

mf *pp*

Measures 57-58: Musical score for measures 57-58. The score is in 4/4 time. Measure 57 features a vocal line starting with a dotted quarter note, followed by a piano accompaniment with eighth notes and chords. Measure 58 continues the piano accompaniment. The dynamic is marked *pp* (pianissimo). The tempo is marked (accel.) (accelerando).

(accel.)

58

8va

pp

f *pp* *f* *pp*

Measures 58-59: Musical score for measures 58-59. The score is in 4/4 time. Measure 58 features a vocal line starting with a dotted quarter note, followed by a piano accompaniment with eighth notes and chords. Measure 59 continues the piano accompaniment. The dynamic is marked *pp* (pianissimo). The tempo is marked (accel.) (accelerando).

♩ = 88 rit. Freely ♩ = 60

59

ff *ff* *p* *pp*

Slightly faster, flowing ♩ = 80

61 *mf* with passionate sorrow

Ge - le - ve - ra de - re - si oy Ge - le - ve - ra

mf 5 5 5

65

de - re - si i - ki da - ğun a - ra - si oy

p *mf* 5 5

68 *p* *mf*

i - ki da - ğun a - ra - si Yu - zun - den si -

71

- lin - - me - sun_ yu - zun - den si - lin - - me - sun

74 *fanguished*

pi - ça - ğu - mun ya - ra - si Yu - zun - den si -

77

- lin - - me - sun_ yu - zun - den si - - lin - - me - sun

8va

8va

8va

rit.

Slightly slower, heavier ♩ = 72

ff suffering

80

pi - ça - ğu - mun ya - ra - si Sev - duğum se -

5

5

5

7

83

-nun aş - kun

8va

5

5

5

7

7

7

86 ***ff***

ci - ğer - le - ru - mi dağ - lar

8va

5

7

rit.

89

15ma

5

7

6

8va

p crystalline

Slower, freely ♩ = 66

92 ***p*** holding back tears

Hiç mi du - şun - me - dun sen

(8)

mf

95

Hiç mi du - şun - me - dun sen oy sev - duğun boy -

(8)

p

99

- le ağ - lar_ sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_

(8)

mf pp

103

emotionally withdrawn

Hiç mi du - şun - - me - dun sen____

8^{va}

outer voices *p*
inner voice *pp*

mf pp

105

Hiç mi du - şun - - me - dun - sen oy_____

(8)

p *pp*

107

sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_____

(8)

pp

109 rit. al fine

sev - duğun boy - le ağ - lar_____

pp

8va

